BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

When checks happen

Relative milestones, not equal time intervals. Your team books tests and reviews results; this map does not confirm completion.

Check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Change / completion	Follow-up
Blood / organ function	FBC, renal, liver baseline	Review results before dose	FBC / renal / liver every cycle	Review recovery before restart	Investigate persisting problems
Steroids / symptoms	Dexamethasone from day before	Confirm ≥3 pre-treatment doses	Neuropathy, fluid retention, infection	Review reductions / recurrence	Report persistent symptoms

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00202 v8 · official regimen · NICE NG101 · bone health and follow-up · ASCO · biomarkers in metastatic breast cancer · ESMO metastatic breast cancer guideline · 2026

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Docetaxel 100 mg/m² · every 3 weeks: treatment and checks

Locally advanced or metastatic breast cancer

Docetaxel 100 mg/m² by IV infusion on Day 1 every 21 days, with dose changes when needed. The number of cycles follows benefit, tolerance and the agreed treatment plan.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Change / completion	Follow-up
Treatment plan NCCP 00202	Baseline eligibility / tests	Day 1 infusion	Repeat every 21 days	Until progression / intolerance	Next treatment plan
Blood / organ function NCCP 00202	FBC, renal, liver baseline	Review results before dose	FBC / renal / liver every cycle	Review recovery before restart	Investigate persisting problems
Steroids / symptoms NCCP 00202	Dexamethasone from day before	Confirm ≥3 pre-treatment doses	Neuropathy, fluid retention, infection	Review reductions / recurrence	Report persistent symptoms
Cancer review METASTATIC · MARKERS	Confirm setting	Agree review plan	Response / symptom review	Next treatment / completion	Agreed surveillance

What each check is for

1 Before treatment

Before the first dose

Locally advanced or metastatic breast cancer. FBC, kidney and liver tests before treatment and every cycle. Review infection, neuropathy, skin/nail toxicity and swelling before the next dose.

Ask / act: Confirm eligibility, test results and medicine list.

Sources: NCCP 00202

2 Other checks

At the specified review points

Review premedication adherence and cumulative fluid retention. Cardiac investigations are based on symptoms and individual risk, not a routine HER2 schedule.

Ask / act: Confirm who arranges and reviews each check.

Sources: NCCP 00202

3 Support and practical plan

At each treatment or phase change

Docetaxel: dexamethasone 8 mg orally twice daily for 3 days starting the day before chemotherapy; at least 3 doses before the infusion. If missed, contact the team; any IV replacement is a consultant decision.

Ask / act: Choose the matching support plan; confirm active medicines.

Sources: NCCP 00202

4 Response and follow-up

Agreed review points

Agree the scan type and review interval for the known disease sites. Review response, symptoms and toxicity together; new or worsening symptoms may need an earlier assessment. Keep the agreed follow-up and report persistent or new symptoms between visits.

Ask / act: Review symptoms, results and patient priorities.

Sources: METASTATIC · MARKERS

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-10-25 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.19